

Foreword

Music is a powerful, memorable presence throughout our lives; it allows us to access, express, or alter our deepest feelings—whether joyful, peaceful, energetic, nostalgic, sorrowful, or angry. Music bonds us to others, and lets us intimately experience our own unique, artistic creativity. Music is one of the most personal ways we have of making sense of our world.

Music is invaluable in the lives of children. Students who learn and make music get to practice all sorts of skills: choosing interpretations, making inventive decisions, solving problems, breaking down difficult issues into manageable subsections, practicing perseverance, and being creative. A musical education helps young people see themselves as artistic beings.

Too often, musical learning is considered a special endeavor reserved for the innately talented. In truth, musical knowledge is not a mysterious gift bestowed upon a lucky few with high musical aptitude. Rather, learning music relies upon understanding and successfully using the systems musicians have created through the years to organize and notate sound. These musical conventions, both aural and written, are best learned in a sequential, orderly way. *Help Your Kids With Music* is just that: a thoughtful, systematic approach to understanding the building blocks of music.

Parents and students with little prior knowledge will benefit from the logical way elements of music are organized in this book. The book progresses methodically explaining the key concepts of music—pitch, rhythm, intervals and keys, melody, harmony, form, instruments, and styles—through clear, easy-to-grasp graphics and text. Detailed annotations of musical examples illustrate how theoretical concepts are used in the real-world practice of composers and performers. Precise definitions of terminology enable readers to use the book as a handy reference guide.

The approach to musicianship presented in this book is organized in a thoughtful way that will allow parents and children working together to “crack the code” of music, and achieve a deeper understanding of this art that is so important to so many of us.

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